



Sucher

A standalone device search – files, contacts and calendar events in one field. This guide covers setup and use.

Version 0.51 · GNU GPLv3 · split off from EdgeTab in 2026

Source & APK: github.com/8818freak/Sucher

All screenshots are from real use – personal content has been redacted.

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1 What is Sucher?

Sucher searches file *names* AND file *content* (text, Office, ODF, PDF, e-books, comic metadata, archive contents and music tags) as well as contacts, calendar events, SMS, calls and captured notifications – all in one field. Unlike an edge panel it isn't an always-on service: open, search, done.

Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no analytics, no internet permission. Runs on any Android device from version 10.

2 Setup

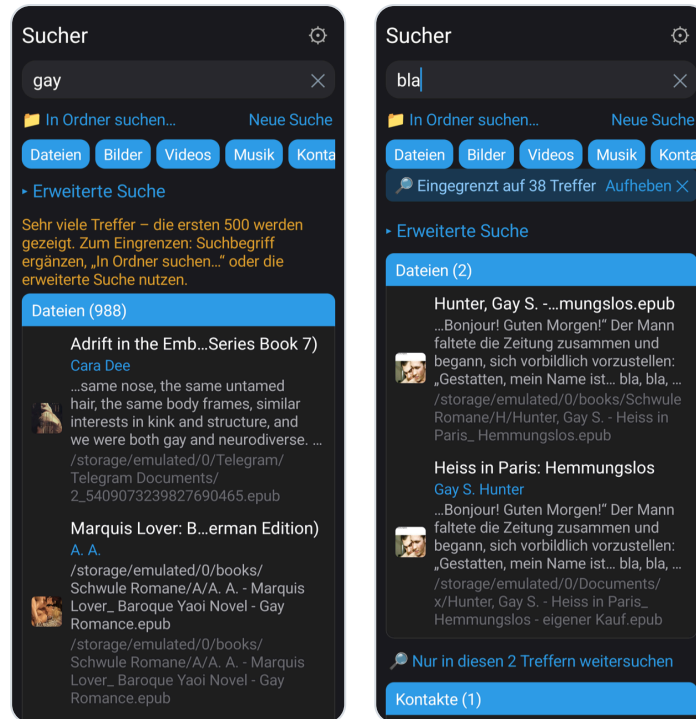
First grant file access (its own system screen) and choose at least one folder. Easiest: the **“Search internal storage”** button adds the whole internal storage directly; **“+ Add another folder”** lets you pick more. Per folder you can enable **“Make content searchable”** – then the full text is indexed in addition to the name (more storage, takes longer).

3 Searching

Type into the field. Category chips narrow the source: *Files* (documents), *Images*, *Videos*, *Music*, *Contacts*, *Events* and *Messages* – each kind gets its own result card. Full-text hits show the matching passage as a snippet; images/PDF/e-books show a thumbnail (generated on demand when displayed). Tapping the thumbnail opens the large preview.

- **✕ in the search field:** clears the query text.
- **New search:** resets everything (text, scopes, advanced fields, filters).
-  **Search in folder....:** limits the search to one folder and its subfolders. Important: navigate to the folder first, then tap **“Search in this folder”** – a blue banner shows the active limit and clears it on request.
- **Recent searches:** a collapsible menu under the search field (while it is empty) lists the last search terms; tapping searches again, “Clear history” empties the list.

There is **no artificial result cap**: the card header states the full hit count and rows load incrementally via “Show more” (in steps of 50). For very many hits, use “Search in folder”, the file type, or “search only within these hits”.

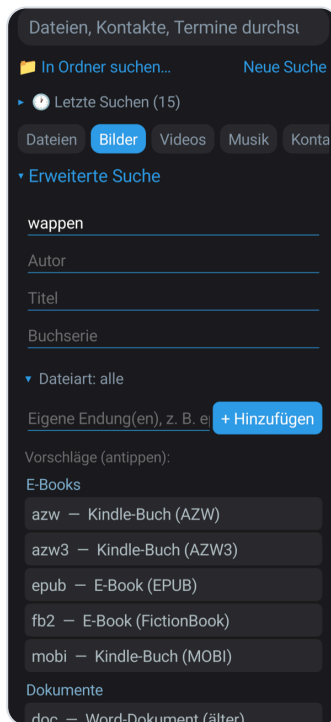


Search home screen

Full-text hits with snippet

4 Advanced search

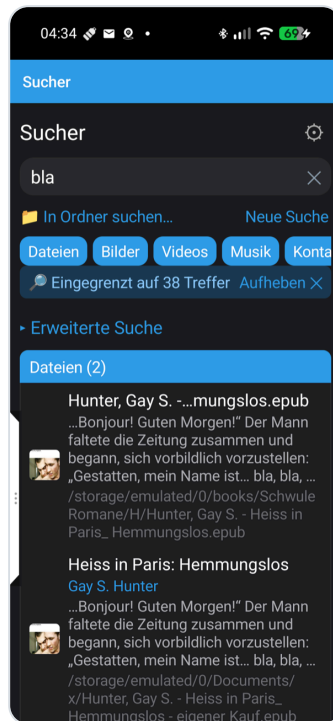
Via “Advanced search”, filter specifically by **author**, **title**, **book series**, **file type** and **date** – ideal for large book and document collections.



Author/title/series/type/date

5 Narrowing results

After any search, “🔍 **search only within these N hits**” restricts every following search to exactly that result set – repeatable, until cleared. A broad first search can thus be refined step by step instead of building one giant combined query.



Narrowing the result set

6 Index & automatic refresh

The index remembers each file's modification time and size and skips everything unchanged on the next run – so follow-up runs are fast. “Reindex now” starts a run by hand; “Automatically refresh in the background every few hours” keeps the index fresh. “Quit Sucher” stops a running index immediately. The progress line names the current phase.

Indexing runs in **three phases**: **Phase 1** captures only metadata (name, type, size, date) of *all* files very quickly – so every file is instantly findable by name, including those in large image, music and video folders. **Phase 2** then fetches full text (for folders with “make content searchable”) and book metadata in batches; **Phase 3** builds thumbnails in batches (they are also created on demand when displayed). This way the expensive full-text work on a large book folder no longer blocks capturing the other folders.

“Reindex” – does it wipe or extend the index?

It **extends/updates** it; it does not wipe it. A run walks the chosen folders and compares each file's modification time with the index: unchanged files are skipped, changed files are re-read, new files are added. Only files that no longer exist (deleted or moved) are removed from the index. An interrupted run therefore never leaves a broken state – just a subset the next run finishes.

What if a file is replaced by one with the same name?

It gets re-indexed. Sucher detects the change by **modification time OR size** – so a replacement is noticed even if it keeps the old modification time (as some tools do) but the size differs. On the next run the metadata and – if content indexing is enabled for that folder – the full text are re-read; the old content is replaced.

Why does indexing sometimes stop and restart?

That is intended and harmless. To save battery, Android gives each background pass only a limited time window; some devices end it after just seconds. Thanks to the fast **Phase 1** (metadata only) even a short window makes big progress, and each pass continues, by modification time/size, exactly where the last left off – nothing is lost, nothing is done twice. The compute-heavy full text (Phase 2) and thumbnails (Phase 3) are caught up gradually. For an immediate full pass, tap **“Reindex now”** and leave the app open (the foreground run has no time limit). Once the index is complete, later runs are short.

If a chosen folder isn't listable (e.g. “/storage/emulated” itself – only “/storage/emulated/0” is accessible), it is automatically mapped to the internal storage and the index is left untouched. A note about it appears in the diagnostics log.

7 Backup & restore

Settings AND the complete search index (all full text already captured) can be backed up to a file and restored from it – handy before switching devices, so the time-consuming indexing isn't needed again.

Thumbnails are deliberately *not* part of the backup (this keeps the file small; they are regenerated on demand). The **“Keep thumbnails permanently”** switch (settings) stores them in app-internal storage – then they survive “clear cache” (including tools like SD Maid); switched off they live in the cache and may be reclaimed under storage pressure.

8 Diagnostics

In the settings, a diagnostics log shows what the indexer did last and where it currently is (folder/file, counters). That makes it possible to see, without a cable, if something ever gets stuck; a “Problematic files” list names files that triggered a hang (and are therefore indexed by name only).